

# SOPHIE LI

[soli@sam.sdu.dk](mailto:soli@sam.sdu.dk) | [sophieli-econ.github.io](https://sophieli-econ.github.io) | Updated on March 30, 2026

Campusvej 55, 5230 Odense, Denmark

## EMPLOYMENT

---

Assistant Professor in Economic History | **University of Southern Denmark** 2024-  
Affiliated with Historical Economics and Development Group (HEDG)

## EDUCATION

---

Ph.D. in Economics | **Boston University** 2024  
B.A. in Economics | **New York University & New York University Shanghai** 2018  
*Magna Cum Laude*

## WORKING PAPERS

---

The Effect of a Woman-Friendly Occupation on Employment: U.S. Postmasters Before WWII,  
*Conditionally Accepted at Explorations in Economic History*  
Returns to Education for Women: Evidence from U.S. Compulsory Schooling Laws, *Submitted*

## SELECTED WORK IN PROGRESS

---

Wartime Medical Education and Disruptions to Physician Labor Supply: Impacts on Physician Quality, the Health Transition, and Innovation (with Christian Møller Dahl, Melissa A. Thomasson, and Anthony Wray)  
Germ Theory at Home: Health Information and Child Mortality during the Epidemiological Transition (with James Feigenbaum and Lauren Hoehn-Velasco)

## PRESENTATIONS

---

Rockwool Foundation Copenhagen Education Network, SOLE Annual Meeting, Boston University, Canadian Economic Association Annual Meeting, IPUMS Data-Intensive Research Conference\*, University of Mannheim\* (\*Scheduled) 2026  
CEPR Applied Micro-Economic History Workshop, CEPR Workshop on Public Health Interventions in the Long Run, EHS Annual Conference, Uppsala Workshop in Economic History, EHA Annual Meeting, SEA Annual Meeting, Copenhagen Business School 2025  
IÉSEG School of Management, Applied Young Economist Webinar, SOLE Annual Meeting, SDU HEDG Mini Workshop for Young Scholars, SSHA Annual Conference 2024  
NBER SI DAE Student Session, World Cliometrics Conference, EHA Annual Meeting, SEA Annual Meeting 2023

## PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

---

**Referee** — *Review of Economics and Statistics, Explorations in Economic History, and Education Economics*

**Conference Reviewer** — European Economic Association Meeting (2026)

## AWARDS AND GRANTS

---

|                                                                                       |           |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| IPUMS Excellence in Research Award   <b>IPUMS</b>                                     | 2023      |
| Rosenstein-Rodan Prize for Best Graduate Student Paper   <b>Boston University</b>     | 2023      |
| Deanne and Gerald Gitner Prize for Excellence in Teaching   <b>Boston University</b>  | 2023      |
| Research Grant \$1,700, Institute for Economic Development   <b>Boston University</b> | 2022      |
| Graduate Student Fellowship   <b>Boston University</b>                                | 2019-2024 |
| University Honors Scholar   <b>New York University</b>                                | 2018      |
| Recognition Award   <b>New York University Shanghai</b>                               | 2017      |
| Dean's List   <b>New York University Shanghai</b>                                     | 2015-2016 |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

---

|                                                                                                           |           |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Instructor   <b>University of Southern Denmark</b>                                                        | 2026-     |
| International Economics (Undergraduate)                                                                   |           |
| Perspectives on Economic Behaviour (Undergraduate)                                                        |           |
| Instructor   <b>University of Southern Denmark</b>                                                        | 2025-     |
| Summer School - Historical Perspectives on Current Economics Issues: Big Data and Applications (Graduate) |           |
| Instructor   <b>University of Southern Denmark</b>                                                        | 2024-2025 |
| Statistics (Undergraduate)                                                                                |           |
| Instructor   <b>Boston University</b>                                                                     | 2022-2023 |
| Labor Economics (Undergraduate)                                                                           |           |
| Teaching Fellow   <b>Boston University</b>                                                                | 2019-2024 |
| Empirical Economic Analysis (Undergraduate)                                                               |           |
| Introduction to Microeconomics (Undergraduate)                                                            |           |

## OTHER ACTIVITIES

---

Representative at Gender Equality Committee | **University of Southern Denmark** 2025-

Organizer of HEDG Mini Workshop | **University of Southern Denmark** 2025-

Joint with Anthony Wray

Organizer of Graduate Student Workshop in Economic History | **Harvard University** 2022

Joint with Ross Mattheis

Co-Chair of Women and Non-Binary People in Economics | **Boston University** 2019-2021

Joint with Vittoria Dicandia and Nayeon Lim

## LANGUAGES

---

Mandarin (Native), English (Fluent), Danish (Beginner)